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Quick Battle Reference

1. Opening effects.
2. Attacker sets a Gambit or passes.
3. Defender sets a Gambit or passes.
4. Set Hands aside; each player draws three to form a Reserve.
5. Reveal and resolve Gambits.
6. Attacker chooses a Tactic or passes.
7. Defender chooses a Tactic or passes.
8. Reveal and resolve Tactics.
9. Resolve pre-dice effects, roll, and determine the winner.
10. Resolve the Aftermath.
11. Gambits go to Graveyards; Tactics and remaining Reserve cards go to Discard Piles.

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Rules Conventions

How it works

Follow the instructions on cards and components. When a specific rule conflicts with a general rule, the specific rule wins. Do as much of an instruction as possible unless the missing part is a required cost, requirement, or target.

Complete rules

- **May** indicates an optional effect. **Must** indicates a required effect.
- Resolve instructions in the order written unless another rule establishes a different order.
- When a card, Leader, faction, Territory, or supplemental-component rule conflicts with a general rule, follow the specific rule.
- Card text changes a card's normal destination only to the extent stated.
- If an instruction cannot be completed in full, complete as much as possible unless the uncompleted instruction is a required cost, requirement, or target.
- An effect resolves only at its stated timing. Revealing a card early does not cause a later portion of its effect to resolve early.
- An effect cannot be canceled or negated after it has resolved.

Playing cards

A card may have several printed effects. The way the card enters play determines which effect is used.

- **Action:** play during an Action Opportunity.
- **Gambit:** set only as a Gambit.
- **Tactic:** choose only as a Tactic.
- **Battle:** use as either a Gambit or Tactic.
- **Mission:** use only as instructed by Intelligence rules.

Faction guides and individual cards may define additional printed headings, such as **Terms**, **Asset**, **Overlay**, **Loan**, or **Effect**. Those headings use the timing and procedure stated by their governing text. They do not make a card eligible as a Gambit or Tactic unless the card also has an eligible Gambit, Tactic, or Battle effect.

Playing a card for one printed effect does not activate its other printed effects unless a rule says otherwise.

Setting a Gambit or choosing a Tactic places the card in battle. It does not resolve immediately unless stated. A face-up Gambit or Tactic still waits for its normal reveal timing unless an effect says otherwise.

Witch Hunter



Archetype: Defense, retaliation, and pursuit

Motto: *You ran. I followed.*

Relentless Pursuit: Once per turn, at the end of the Aftermath of a battle an opponent initiated against you and lost, you may spend 2 Conviction. End their turn, then move one position toward their end of the Gauntlet. This movement may start a battle; you are the attacker. No Action Opportunity occurs before that battle.

Withdrawal has no loser, so neither Leader ability triggers from it.

Inquisition-specific rules

Discard Pile order

The top card is the most recently placed card unless a rule changes the order. Choosing cards from a Discard Pile does not reorder the rest.

Combined deckbuilding value

When an effect allows several cards within a combined value limit, add their printed values. The total cannot exceed the limit.

No Martyrs

No Martyrs prevents the losing opponent from benefiting from effects they control that trigger from that loss or resulting retreat. It does not prevent harmful consequences, the retreat itself, or effects controlled by another player.

For a sliding tracker, place the indicated Leader or Reference Card over the tracker. Fully cover the tracker at 0, then slide the covering card until its bottom edge aligns with the current value.

- A counter, dial, written record, or other substitute may be used when it shows the same public information clearly and unambiguously.
- A reference card is a reminder, not a separate rules authority. If its shortened text omits a detail, follow this rulebook and the definitive faction guide.
- A double-sided supplemental card changes state only when its governing rule tells you to flip it. Keep any attached or bound cards with it so both players can identify the relationship.
- Supplemental components have no deckbuilding value and are not eligible as Gambits, Tactics, costs, collateral, Transmutation cards, Treasury cards, or other playable cards unless a rule explicitly says otherwise.
- Each player supplies and controls their own faction package unless a faction rule identifies a shared supply. In a mirror match, keep the two players' components separated and oriented toward their owners.

Military package

Use the selected Leader Card and the **Command Tracker**. Begin at 0 Command with the tracker fully covered by the Leader. Slide the Leader to 1 or 2 whenever Command changes. The Leader Card lists that Leader's three Orders; spend Command only at an Order's stated timing.

Diplomat package

Use the selected Leader Card, **Influence Tracker**, double-sided **Diplomat Reference Card**, and nine double-sided **Proposal / Treaty Article cards**. Begin at 1 Influence and place every Proposal with its Proposal side up. Lower the tracker when Influence is staked or spent and raise it when Influence returns or is gained. Flip an unratified Proposal to its Treaty Article side only when it is ratified. Leave ratified Articles face up so progress toward the Peace Treaty is public.

Financier package

Use the selected Leader Card, **Financier Reference Card**, public **Capital Ledger**, and eight identical **Deed Cards** in a shared supply. Begin with 0 Capital and an empty Treasury. Record every Capital gain, spend, loss, and end-turn reduction as a new Ledger transaction with a running Balance. When a Deed is bought, place one Deed Card beside its Territory on the owner's side; move it during a buyout and return it to the supply if it becomes unowned. A Deed is not an Asset or Overlay.

Intelligence package

Use the selected Leader Card, **Mission Reference Card**, **Operations Reference Card**, **Intel Tracker**, and **Operation Progress Tracker**. Both tracked values begin at 0 and have no maximum. Place the Intel Tracker beneath the Operations Reference and the Operation Progress Tracker beneath the Mission Reference, then slide the covering card to the current value. Record values beyond the printed track separately. An Active Mission or Special Operation is an eligible card from the Playable Deck placed face down near the Leader; the reference cards themselves never become Missions.

Mystics package

Use the selected Leader Card, **Mystics Reference Card**, and the three double-sided **Rite cards**: Rite of Echoes, Rite of Blood, and Rite of Crossing. Begin with every Rite incomplete-side up. Keep a begun Rite and any cards bound to it together. Flip the Rite when it is completed; reset it to the incomplete side when

Cost	Purge
1	Choose one: put the top card of the opponent's Discard Pile in their Graveyard; or choose up to two cards there with combined value 2 or less and put them in their Graveyard.
2	Choose one opposing Asset and put it in its owner's Graveyard.
3	The opponent chooses one card from their Hand and puts it in their Graveyard.
4	Reveal the opponent's Hand. Choose one card and put it in their Graveyard.

A Purge uses the Action Opportunity but is not playing a card. Final Judgment may permit a Purge outside an Action Opportunity.

Purification

At the beginning of the opponent's turn, after their normal start-of-turn draw attempt, if they draw no cards because both their Draw Pile and Discard Pile are empty, immediately win through **Purification**.

A failed Reserve draw or effect-generated draw does not trigger Purification.

2. Building a Deck

How it works

Choose one faction and one of its two Leaders. Build a Playable Deck of at least 30 cards with no more than 60 total deckbuilding value. Use Neutral cards and cards from your chosen faction. Then choose three different Territories.

Complete rules

Choose a faction and Leader

Choose one faction, then choose one Leader belonging to that faction. Both players may choose the same faction or Leader.

The Leader Card begins face up and remains available throughout the game.

Build the Playable Deck

A Playable Deck must contain:

- at least **30 cards**;
- no more than **60 total deckbuilding value**; and
- only Neutral cards and cards belonging to the selected faction.

Unless marked **Unique**, a card may appear in any quantity permitted by the available card pool. A Unique card is limited to one copy in the Playable Deck.

Choose Territories

Choose exactly three different Territory Cards.

- No more than one may be an **Arena**.
- Territory Cards are not part of the Playable Deck.
- Territories do not count toward the 30-card minimum or 60-value maximum.
- Both players may choose the same Territory titles.

Supplemental components

Prepare all components required by the chosen faction and Leader.

Unless a rule says otherwise, supplemental components:

- are not part of the Playable Deck;
- are not shuffled into the Draw Pile;
- cannot be drawn, played, discarded, banked, or placed in the Graveyard; and
- do not count toward deck size or deckbuilding value.

19. Inquisition

How it works

The Inquisition gains **Conviction** when opposing cards are permanently lost after battles. It also sends opposing Tactics to the Graveyard through **Condemnation** and gains additional Conviction when the opponent plays or reveals Arcane cards through **Blasphemy**.

Spend Conviction on **Purges** that remove cards and Assets. If the opponent eventually cannot make their normal start-of-turn draw because both their Draw Pile and Discard Pile are empty, win through **Purification**.

Complete rules

Element	Inquisition rule
Victory	Run the Gauntlet or achieve Purification.
Resource	Conviction, maximum 4.
Normal gain	First time each turn opposing cards enter the Graveyard during the Aftermath of a battle involving you.
Doctrine	Condemnation and Blasphemy.
Faction action	Purge.
Leaders	Grand Inquisitor and Witch Hunter.
Faction pool	12 Inquisition card titles.
Arcane card	Heresy.

Components and setup

An Inquisition Deck includes:

- one Inquisition Leader Card: **Grand Inquisitor** or **Witch Hunter**;
- one Inquisition Doctrine Reference Card;
- one Purge Reference Card;
- one Conviction Tracker; and
- any Inquisition cards included in the Playable Deck.

Begin with 0 Conviction. Slide the Leader over the tracker to show 0–4.

3. Setup

How it works

Shuffle your Playable Deck, arrange your three Territories secretly, then join them to your opponent's three Territories. Reveal the full Gauntlet, place your token just before your end, draw three cards, and roll to see who goes first.

Keep your permanent Hand, temporary battle cards, discard pile, Graveyard, Assets, and faction components in clearly separate areas.

Complete rules

Prepare the game in this order:

1. **Prepare the Draw Pile.** Shuffle the Playable Deck and place it face down. Leave room for the Discard Pile and Graveyard.
2. **Arrange Territories.** Secretly arrange the three Territory Cards in a line facing their owner.
3. **Form the Gauntlet.** Join both Territory lines to create one six-Territory column.
4. **Reveal Territories.** Reveal all six simultaneously. They remain face up unless an effect says otherwise.
5. **Prepare faction components.** Place Leaders, trackers, references, and supplemental components according to their rules.
6. **Place Player Tokens.** Place each token immediately before the Territory at that player's end.
7. **Draw opening Hands.** Each player draws three cards.
8. **Determine first player.** Each player rolls one die. Higher result goes first; reroll ties.

Recommended play areas

Each player should maintain distinct areas for:

- Draw Pile;
- Discard Pile;
- Graveyard;
- Hand;
- Asset Bank;
- Leader and supplemental components;
- Reserve;
- Gambit; and
- Tactic.

Cards in different zones must remain visibly separate even when space is limited.

Spirit Walker



Archetype: Rite endurance and protective sacrifice

Motto: *The spirits remember what the living abandon.*

Guardians of the Circle: The first time on your turn that you lose a battle and a begun Rite would be interrupted, you may put one Arcane card from your Hand in your Graveyard. If you do, that Rite is not interrupted.

Guardians of the Circle cannot preserve a continuing position requirement and does not protect the Ritual of Ascendance.

Mystics-specific rules

Arcane trait

Arcane is a trait, not faction allegiance. Mystics cards are Arcane, and cards from other pools may also have the trait.

Entering the Graveyard

A card enters the Graveyard before an effect such as Grave Ward moves it elsewhere. An entry trigger still resolves even if the card immediately leaves.

Exchange

To exchange two cards, move each simultaneously to the other's previous zone. Both must remain eligible and present. If either cannot move, no exchange occurs.

Movement

Advance, hold, or withdraw. Resolve any battle caused by movement immediately. When movement begins a battle, that movement ends and all unused movement is lost.

Cleanup

Resolve end-of-turn effects. If the active player has more than three cards in Hand, they discard until they have three. The turn ends.

After completing all three Rites, during an Action Opportunity after movement, instead of playing a card for its Action effect, bind:

- one Arcane card from your Hand;
- one Arcane card from your Discard Pile; and
- one Arcane card from your Graveyard.

This begins the Ritual of Ascendance.

Convergence

While the Ritual is underway, during a battle you initiated, add +1 to your battle total for each card bound to the Ritual.

With all three cards bound, Convergence normally gives +3.

Completion

Initiate a battle while all three Ritual cards remain bound. If you win that battle, complete the Ritual and immediately win the game.

The Mystic must initiate the final battle.

Interruption

If you lose any battle before Ritual completion, the Ritual is interrupted. Put all three Ritual-bound cards in your Graveyard.

Completed Rites remain complete. You may begin the Ritual again later.

Withdrawal neither completes nor interrupts the Ritual because it has no winner or loser.

6. Battles

How it works

A battle begins when one player enters the other's position. The moving player is the attacker and the other player is the defender.

First resolve effects that happen as the battle opens. Each player may then set one card from their Hand as a **Gambit**. Gambits are costly because they normally go to the Graveyard afterward.

Next, each player sets their Hand aside and draws three temporary cards to form a **Reserve**. Reveal Gambits, then each player may choose one Reserve card as a **Tactic**. Reveal Tactics, resolve the card effects, and roll dice. The higher battle total wins. If the totals are tied while the defender controls the contested Territory, Defender's Advantage means the defender wins the tie. Defender's Advantage is a tie rule, not the ordinary advantage mechanic that changes how dice are rolled.

Complete rules

The player whose movement or effect starts the battle is the **attacker**. The other player is the **defender**. Those roles remain fixed through the Aftermath of the battle.

Resolve each battle in this order:

1. Resolve opening effects.
2. Set Gambits.
3. Set Hands aside and form Reserves.
4. Reveal Gambits.
5. Choose Tactics.
6. Reveal Tactics.
7. Resolve the battle.
8. Resolve the Aftermath of the battle.

1. Opening effects

Establish the attacker, defender, and contested position. Resolve effects that occur when a battle would begin, when a battle opens, or before Gambits are set.

A mechanic such as Terms may prevent the pending battle. If no battle is fought, battle, victory, loss, and Aftermath triggers do not occur.

2. Set Gambits

Unless an effect changes the order:

1. the attacker sets up to one eligible Gambit face down or passes;
2. the defender sets up to one eligible Gambit face down or passes.

A card with a **Gambit** or **Battle** effect is eligible. Setting a Gambit is optional.

Complete rules

Beginning a Rite

During an Action Opportunity after movement, instead of playing a card for its Action effect, begin one incomplete Rite by paying its beginning cost.

- You may have only one begun but incomplete Rite.
- You may begin any uncompleted Rite; there is no required order.
- A Rite cannot complete during the turn it begins.
- Only one Rite may be completed per turn.
- If interrupted, it resets and paid costs are not returned unless stated.

Progression

- Complete the first Rite to unlock **Invocation**.
- Complete the second Rite to unlock **Transmutation**.
- Complete the third Rite to unlock **Convergence** and permission to begin the **Ritual of Ascendancy**.

Bound cards

A card bound to a Rite, Ritual, or another card is outside normal zones.

- A face-up bound card is public.
- A face-down bound card may be inspected only by its owner.
- A bound card cannot be played, moved, or affected except as instructed by the effect to which it is bound.
- If the binding effect ends and gives no destination, put the bound card in its owner's Graveyard.

Invocation

Once per turn, when an Arcane card you play, set, or choose resolves its Action, Gambit, Tactic, or Battle effect, you may move one card from your Graveyard to your Discard Pile.

A copied effect does not trigger Invocation unless the Arcane card itself resolves another printed effect through being played, set, or chosen again.

Transmutation

Once per turn, before dice are rolled in a battle involving you, you may put one card from your Hand in your Graveyard. Add its deckbuilding value to your battle total.

The card is not played and none of its printed effects resolve. Supplemental components cannot be used.

The three Rites

Rite of Echoes

Beginning cost: Bind one chosen card from your Graveyard face up beneath this Rite. Then bind one card from your Hand face down beneath it whose title matches at least one other card in your Playable Deck.

If a tie is not resolved by Defender's Advantage or another effect, both players reroll. Cards and effects already in use remain active.

Shared-timing rule

When multiple controlled effects resolve at the same time:

1. the attacker resolves one effect they control;
2. the defender resolves one effect they control;
3. continue alternating until no effects remain at that timing.

Each player chooses the order of effects they control. Simultaneous reveal does not mean simultaneous resolution.

Multiple and additional Gambits or Tactics

An effect may allow a player to set or choose more than the normal limit. Unless stated otherwise, that permission is optional.

When a player may choose more than one Tactic, they choose all of them simultaneously. Each remains a separate Tactic.

When an effect permits an **additional Tactic** after the normal choice:

- the card must have an eligible Tactic or Battle effect;
- if Tactics are already revealed, play it face up;
- resolve only effects whose timing remains available;
- do not reopen Tactic choices, reveal timing, Surveillance, or Interference; and
- follow the normal Tactic destination unless stated otherwise.

Replacements and revisions

A replacement takes the same role as the card it replaces.

- A replacement Gambit must be Gambit-eligible.
- A replacement Tactic must be Tactic-eligible.
- Place it in the face state instructed by the replacing effect.
- Replacement does not reopen an earlier timing window.
- Only unresolved effects whose timing remains available can resolve.

When an effect lets a player revise a choice, the revised choice does not create another reveal, Surveillance, Interference, or replacement opportunity unless stated otherwise.

Reveal and information

To reveal a face-down card, turn it face up and leave it face up.

To reveal a Hand or Reserve, its owner shows the entire zone to the opponent. The cards remain in that zone.

Spymaster



Archetype: Mission tempo and operational coordination

Motto: *Information never rests. Momentum is the weapon.*

Mission Control: Once per turn, after completing a normal Mission, you may immediately start another eligible Mission from your Hand without using an Action Opportunity. It cannot complete that turn. Mission Control cannot start a Special Operation.

Intelligence-specific rules

Counterintelligence

When Counterintelligence prevents an opposing effect from revealing a Hand, Reserve, face-down battle card, or Territory, it prevents the entire opposing revealing effect, not only the information portion. Rules-mandated reveals are unaffected.

Watchtower

When the controller of Watchtower defends there, the attacker sets their Gambit face up or passes; the defender sets normally. Because the attacker's Gambit was never face down, Counterintelligence does not prevent the reveal. Intelligence may use Direct Interference for 2 Intel.

7. The Aftermath of the Battle

How it works

After the dice determine a winner, resolve the consequences of the battle. The loser retreats, the winner takes or keeps the contested position, and any additional retreat or capture effects occur. Then battle cards go to their normal destinations.

Gambits go to the Graveyard. Tactics and cards left in Reserve go to the Discard Pile. Remember: **Gambits go to the Graveyard.**

Complete rules

Resolve the Aftermath in this order:

1. Determine the battle result.
2. Apply effects that replace losing with withdrawal.
3. If the battle still has a winner, resolve immediate result triggers.
4. Resolve normal retreat and occupation, including replacements.
5. Resolve additional retreats and final-position effects.
6. Resolve other Aftermath effects that occur before cards leave battle.
7. Move battle cards to their destinations.
8. Resolve effects triggered by those destinations.
9. Resolve effects at the end of the Aftermath, including follow-up movement.

Normal result

Unless an effect says otherwise:

- a losing attacker returns to the position from which they entered;
- a losing defender retreats one position toward their own end;
- a winning attacker occupies the contested position; and
- a winning defender remains there.

Additional retreats resolve one position at a time. A player cannot retreat through the opponent. A player on their final Territory may retreat beyond the Gauntlet normally.

Normal card destinations

During the destination step:

- Gambits go to their owners' Graveyards;
- Tactics go to their owners' Discard Piles; and
- cards remaining in Reserve go to their owners' Discard Piles.

A card-specific instruction overrides the normal destination.

- The owner may choose one eligible replacement from the same source or pass.
- A replacement is placed face down unless the effect says otherwise.
- The replacement creates no new Surveillance, Interference, reveal, or response opportunity.

If an effect prevents Surveillance or Interference, the Intel remains spent and the relevant once-per-battle opportunity is still used.

Direct Interference

When an opposing effect sets or chooses a card face up and the normal Surveillance reveal is unnecessary, Intelligence may spend 2 Intel to Interfere with that card directly at the same response timing. This does not use Surveillance but does use the relevant stage's Interference opportunity.

Intelligence mirrors

At each choice stage:

1. the first player makes the relevant choice;
2. the second player may use Surveillance and Interference, then makes their choice;
3. the first player may use Surveillance and Interference, then revise their own choice if allowed; and
4. the stage closes.

8. Withdrawal and Retreat

How it works

Withdrawal is leaving a battle without determining a winner. **Retreat** is forced movement after losing. They are not the same.

When an effect causes withdrawal, the battle ends immediately. No one wins or loses, so win, loss, and retreat effects do not happen. The players still clean up their battle cards normally.

Complete rules

Voluntary movement withdrawal

During the Movement step, a player may move one position toward their own end. This is ordinary movement and does not begin a battle.

Effect-caused withdrawal from battle

Unless the effect says otherwise, withdrawal ends the battle immediately.

- Do not resolve remaining Battle effects.
- Do not roll dice.
- There is no winner or loser.
- Win, loss, and retreat triggers do not occur.
- Resolve withdrawal movement, then normal battle destinations and cleanup.

Movement:

- an attacking player returns to the position from which they entered;
- a defending player moves one position toward their own end, and the attacker occupies the contested position;
- if both withdraw, move the attacker first, then the defender.

Withdrawal during opening effects

If an effect causes one or both players to withdraw during opening effects and prevents the pending battle, use the same attacker and defender movement above. Because no battle is fought:

- no player wins, loses, or retreats;
- no battle or Aftermath triggers occur; and
- no battle-card destinations or cleanup occur.

The established attacker and defender roles are used only to determine the withdrawal movement. Resolve any remaining instructions from the effect or accepted Terms after that movement.

If a battle following refused Terms ends through withdrawal, return the Stake and do not impose or ratify the Proposal unless a specific rule says otherwise.

A completed Mission gives 1 Operation Progress and Intel equal to the card's deckbuilding value. When Operation Progress exceeds the number of Territories the opponent controls, you may begin a Special Operation.

Complete rules

Intel

Intel begins at 0, cannot fall below 0, and has no maximum. Spend it for Surveillance, Interference, Fieldcraft, Mission abortion, Special Operation completion, and card effects.

Operation Progress

Operation Progress begins at 0 and is not normally spent. Each completed normal Mission adds 1, regardless of card value.

Starting a Mission

During an Action Opportunity after movement, instead of playing a card for its Action effect, place one eligible Intelligence card from your Hand face down near your Leader as your **Active Mission**.

- You may inspect it at any time.
- You may have only one Active Mission.
- You cannot have an Active Mission and Special Operation simultaneously.
- It cannot complete during the turn it begins.
- Its printed requirement counts only while it is the Active Mission.
- Starting it is not playing the card for a printed effect.

Completing a Mission

During an Action Opportunity after movement, instead of playing a card for its Action effect, reveal and complete the Active Mission if its requirement has been satisfied.

1. Gain 1 Operation Progress.
2. Gain Intel equal to its deckbuilding value.
3. Put it in your Discard Pile.

Satisfying the requirement does not complete it automatically.

Aborting and failing

During an Action Opportunity after movement, reveal the Active Mission and spend Intel equal to its value to abort it. Put it in the Discard Pile. Aborting is not failure.

A Mission fails only when a rule, effect, or continuing requirement causes failure. Reveal it and put it in the Graveyard.

Starting a Special Operation

You may start a Special Operation only when:

- your Operation Progress exceeds the number of Territories the opponent controls;
- you have no Active Mission or Special Operation; and
- you have an eligible Intelligence card in Hand.

9. Territory Control

How it works

Your token shows where you are. A Territory's orientation shows who controls it. Winning a battle lets you occupy an opposing Territory, but you normally do not capture it immediately. You must still be there at the start of your next turn.

This gives the opponent a chance to counterattack before control changes.

Complete rules

Control

The player a Territory faces controls it. Control does not require occupation.

Each player begins controlling the three Territories on their side. Control changes only through capture or an effect that explicitly changes it.

Occupation

A player normally occupies the position containing their token. During an unresolved attack, the defender remains the occupant until the result is resolved.

A player may occupy a Territory controlled by the opponent.

Capture

At the start of a player's turn, if they occupy a Territory they do not control, they capture it by rotating the Territory to face them.

A captured Territory remains under that player's control until the opponent captures it or an effect changes control.

Counterattack window

Because ordinary capture occurs at the start of the occupying player's next turn, the current controller normally receives one turn to drive the occupier away.

- has a Deed;
- counts toward Capital and Asset limits when controlled;
- generates income when its Deed is owned;
- expands Controlling Interest; and
- uses the normal capped cost formulas.

Self-tracking cards

- Speculation remains face up beside its selected Territory and is neither an Asset nor Overlay.
- Capital Gains is placed beneath its selected Treasury card.
- Margin Loan holds its collateral beneath it.

Tariffs and Asset replacement

You cannot bank Tariffs while another copy you control is banked. During the turn Tariffs is banked, you cannot voluntarily cause it to leave play, including replacing it to make room for another Asset.

Underwriting and Property Dues may be replaced normally. Replacing Margin Loan before resolution causes default.

11. Game Zones

How it works

Keep cards in clearly defined places. Your **Hand** is your permanent private set of cards. A **Reserve** exists only during one battle. The **Discard Pile** cycles back into the Draw Pile, while the **Graveyard** normally does not.

Complete rules

Draw Pile

The face-down pile formed from the Playable Deck.

Hand

The private cards held by a player. The normal Hand limit is three at end-of-turn cleanup.

Setting a Hand aside during battle does not move its cards to another zone.

Reserve

A temporary private zone formed during one battle. It is separate from the Hand. Its owner may inspect it freely.

At the end of the battle, cards remaining in Reserve normally go to the Discard Pile.

Gambit area

The area containing cards set as Gambits for the current battle. Gambits normally go to the Graveyard during the Aftermath.

Tactic area

The area containing cards chosen or played as Tactics for the current battle. Tactics normally go to the Discard Pile during the Aftermath.

Discard Pile

A face-up pile of recyclable cards. When a Draw Pile cannot complete a draw, shuffle the Discard Pile to form a new Draw Pile.

Graveyard

A face-up pile outside normal circulation. Cards there are not reshuffled unless an effect moves them.

Asset Bank

The public area containing a player's banked Assets.

Banker



Archetype: Collateral, planned purchases, and flexible financing

Motto: *Credit closes the distance.*

Line of Credit: The first time on your turn that you would buy or buy out a Deed, you may use one card from your Hand or Treasury as collateral. - It contributes payment equal to its deckbuilding value. - It cannot contribute more than half the purchase cost, rounded down. - Pay the remaining cost with Capital. - Put the collateral in your Discard Pile after the purchase. - Unused collateral value is lost. - Line of Credit applies only to Deed purchases and buyouts.

12. Actions and Assets

How it works

During your Action Opportunity, play one card for its Action effect or use a faction action. Most one-time Actions go to the Discard Pile. Some cards become **Assets**, which stay in play and provide later effects.

Your Asset limit equals the number of Territories you control. When banking a new Asset at the limit, you may discard one existing Asset to make room.

Complete rules

Action effects

To play a card for its Action effect:

1. play it from Hand during an Action Opportunity;
2. satisfy all requirements and costs;
3. resolve the Action effect; and
4. put it in the Discard Pile unless it becomes an Asset or Overlay or specifies another destination.

Assets

A card is an Asset only when an effect banks it in the Asset Bank.

A player's Asset limit equals the number of Territories they control.

- A Territory occupied but not controlled does not increase the limit.
- If the limit falls below the number of Assets controlled, immediately discard Assets until within the limit.
- An inactive Asset still counts unless a rule says otherwise.

Replacing an Asset

When banking an Asset at the Asset limit, the player may discard one Asset they control to make room and bank the new Asset during the same Action Opportunity.

An effect that prevents an Asset from leaving play also prevents replacing it this way. Any consequence of the replaced Asset leaving play still occurs.

Activating and discarding Assets

Use **activate** when using an Asset's printed ability. If the effect requires the Asset to be discarded, put it in its owner's Discard Pile unless stated otherwise.

Whenever a player could play a card for its Action effect, they may instead discard one Asset they control. This uses the Action Opportunity.

Territory state from buyer's perspective	Modifier
You control it	-1
You occupy it but do not control it	0
You neither control nor occupy it	+1

For an unowned Deed, buyout premium is 0.

For a Deed owned by an opposing Financier:

Buyout premium = min(Deeds the opposing owner owns, 6)

Income

After the Capture step at the start of your turn, gain 1 Capital for each Deed you own. Income may temporarily exceed the Capital limit.

Controlling Interest

When you own the Deeds to every Territory currently in the Gauntlet, immediately win through

Controlling Interest.

A Territory added to the Gauntlet has a normal Deed and expands the required portfolio.

Play the Market

During an Action Opportunity after movement, instead of playing a card for its Action effect, discard one card from Hand and roll one die:

Roll	Result
1	Put the card in your Graveyard; gain 0 Capital.
2–3	Gain 1 Capital.
4–5	Gain Capital equal to the card's deckbuilding value.
6	Gain Capital equal to twice the card's deckbuilding value.

Subsidize

Before dice are rolled in a battle involving you, spend Capital to add to your battle total.

Bonus	Total cost
+1	1 Capital
+2	3 Capital
+3	6 Capital
+4	10 Capital

The progression continues without a fixed maximum. Each additional +1 costs one more Capital than the previous increment. Capital spent through Subsidize is lost regardless of the result.

14. Military

How it works

The Military turns battle victories into **Command**, then spends Command on Leader-specific **Orders**. The General uses Orders to attack, reinforce, and pursue. The Commandant uses them to defend, repel, and capture.

Military has no alternate victory condition. It wins by running the Gauntlet.

Complete rules

Element	Military rule
Victory	Run the Gauntlet.
Resource	Command, maximum 2.
Resource gain	The first time each turn you win a battle, gain 1 Command.
Leaders	General and Commandant.
Faction pool	12 Military card titles.
Unique card	Shock and Awe, cost 5; maximum one copy per Playable Deck.

Components and setup

A Military Deck includes:

- one Military Leader Card: **General** or **Commandant**;
- one Military Command Tracker; and
- any Military cards included in the Playable Deck.

Place the chosen Leader face up. Place the Command Tracker beneath it, fully covered, to show 0 Command. Slide the Leader upward to the 1 or 2 registration line as Command changes.

Command and Orders

How it works

The first battle you win during each turn gives you 1 Command, even when you win while defending on the opponent's turn. Spend Command only when an Order reaches its printed timing.

Complete rules

Military may have up to 2 Command.

The first time each turn the Military player wins a battle, gain 1 Command. This trigger may occur during either player's turn. Winning while already at 2 Command still counts as the first Military victory of that

16. Financiers

How it works

Financiers build economic power. They place cards in a **Treasury** to increase their Capital limit, gain and spend **Capital**, and buy **Deeds** connected to Territories.

Deed ownership is independent of who occupies or controls the Territory. Own the Deeds to every Territory currently in the Gauntlet to win through **Controlling Interest**.

Complete rules

Element	Financier rule
Victory	Run the Gauntlet or achieve Controlling Interest.
Resource	Capital, minimum 0; maximum determined by the Capital limit.
Capital limit	Territories you control plus total deckbuilding value in Treasury.
Income	After the Capture step, gain 1 Capital per Deed you own.
Leaders	Banker and Executive.
Faction pool	12 Financier card titles.
Unique card	Corner the Market, cost 5; maximum one copy per Playable Deck.

Components and setup

A Financier Deck includes:

- one Financier Leader Card: **Banker** or **Executive**;
- one Financier Reference Card;
- one public Capital Ledger;
- eight identical full-size Deed Cards in a shared supply; and
- any Financier cards included in the Playable Deck.

Begin with 0 Capital and an empty Treasury. Place Deed Cards in the shared unowned supply.

Capital, Treasury, and Deeds

How it works

Capital is public and pays for Deeds, Subsidize, and card effects. Your Capital limit rises when you control Territories or place valuable cards in Treasury. You may temporarily exceed the limit, but excess Capital is lost at the end of each turn.

During an Action Opportunity after movement, you may place a card in Treasury, buy a Deed, or Play the Market instead of playing an Action card.

General



Archetype: Attack, forward pressure, and tempo

Motto: *Forward. Again.*

Orders

Onward — 1 Command: During your Movement step, before a battle begins, move one additional position. This movement may start a battle.

Rally — 1 Command: Before dice are rolled in a battle you initiated, add +1 to your battle total.

Rout — 2 Command: At the end of the Aftermath of a battle you initiated and won, advance one position. This movement may start another battle.

Onward cannot be used after a battle. Rout creates a new movement sequence after the completed Aftermath.

Capitulation

Stake: 0

Requirement: You must be defending.

Accepted: You withdraw. The opponent remains in or occupies the contested position, then draws one card. **Refused:** If you lose, draw two cards.

Open Channels

Stake: 1

Requirement: You must have a card in Hand.

Accepted: Both players reveal their Hands, then withdraw. The opponent draws one card. **Refused:** Reveal the opponent's Hand. When forming your Reserve, draw one additional card.

Mutual Disarmament

Stake: 1

Requirement: Both players must have a card in Hand.

Accepted: Each player discards one card from Hand. The opponent draws one card, then both players withdraw. **Refused:** You may discard one card from Hand. If you do, draw one additional card when forming your Reserve.

Prisoner Exchange

Stake: 1

Requirement: Each player must have a card in their Graveyard.

Accepted: Each player may move one card from their Graveyard to their Discard Pile. Then both players withdraw. **Refused:** If you lose, you may move one card from your Graveyard to your Discard Pile.

Rebuilding Pact

Stake: 1

Requirement: You must have a card in Hand that can be banked as an Asset.

Accepted: Each player may bank one eligible card from Hand as an Asset without using an Action Opportunity. Then both players withdraw. **Refused:** During the Aftermath of the battle, you may bank one eligible card from Hand as an Asset without using an Action Opportunity.

Ultimatum

Stake: 2

Requirement: None

Additional Tactics

Military effects may add Tactics after the normal Tactic reveal. Play such a card face up. Its effect must still be able to resolve at that timing. It does not reopen normal Tactic choice, Surveillance, Interference, or reveal windows.

Conflicting victory benefits

War Crimes and Shock and Awe may prohibit movement, capture, or Orders resulting from the same victory. Apply only combinations of effects that can legally resolve together.

Ambassador



Archetype: Agreement, card flow, and settlement

Motto: *Words first. War last.*

Cordiality: Once per turn, after the opponent accepts your Terms, draw one card.

Complete rules

Influence

Diplomats begin with 1 Influence and may have up to 10.

When Influence is staked or spent, lower the tracker. Staked Influence is unavailable until the Terms resolve.

Influence gained above 10 is lost.

Offering Terms

Terms occur during opening effects after the attacker, defender, and contested position are established but before Gambits are set.

To offer Terms:

1. choose one eligible Proposal;
2. confirm its Requirement;
3. confirm enough available Influence for its Stake;
4. lower available Influence by the Stake; and
5. the opponent accepts or refuses.

A Diplomat may normally offer one Proposal for a pending battle.

Diplomat mirrors

Only one player may offer Terms for a pending battle.

1. The attacker has the first opportunity.
2. If the attacker passes, the defender may offer.
3. Once either player offers Terms, the other cannot offer Terms for that battle, even if the Proposal is refused.

Accepted Terms

When Terms are accepted:

1. no battle is fought;
2. resolve the Proposal's **Accepted** effect;
3. return the Stake;
4. if the Proposal is unratified, flip it to its Treaty Article side;
5. if newly ratified, gain Influence equal to its Stake; and
6. resolve effects that occur after acceptance.

Accepted Terms do not create a battle, winner, loser, retreat, or Aftermath.

A Stake-0 Proposal grants no Influence merely for being accepted.

Refused Terms

When Terms are refused:

1. resolve the Proposal's **Refused** effect and any refusal modifiers;
2. continue to Set Gambits;
3. before dice, the Diplomat may use Leverage; and